

ly, they are commercial software (that is, they are paid). Still, one of the best ones we found was FreeProxy which is, well, free.

12.1.1 All About FreeProxy

Available from www.handcraftedsoftware.org, FreeProxy is developed by Hand-Crafted Software, and according to them, FreeProxy is “free of any spyware, malware, advertisements etc. and is a 100% pure fully functional proxy server.” Well, after all, when you get something like this for free, the value for money becomes infinite.

Skip the rest of this subsection if you want to directly get to using FreeProxy... After many betas and testing, FreeProxy was released as version 3.5 in December 2003, with an update within a week of its release. Over the next one month, it underwent a series of assaulting upgrades to improve tunnelling performance, error reporting, and other general tweaks.

A new release (build 1450) was released in May 2004 after a couple of months in beta testing. Being freeware, implied warranties are non-existent and upgrades to the software are basically the only way to keep it working right.

Release v3.81 was done in October 2004, which greatly improved performance, and this was touted as the “first stable release.” However, the v3.8x series had a set of security issues related to user access, so much so that one Web site that had reviewed it and had it for download claimed it was “probably good for a quick game of Quake or two, but not secure enough to invite the whole neighborhood over.”

This is probably what decided that a more secure version needed to come out and led to version 3.92 with ban lists and support for Windows Groups.

Since this April, a new (and of course, the latest thus far) version has been out, and it has been renamed “FreeProxy Internet Suite 4.00” since it incorporates full-fledged SMTP and POP server